

MICHAEL MWANZA

Fullstack Developer & AI Engineer

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SUMMARY

Fullstack Developer & AI Engineer with 3+ years building and shipping production applications — 3 client platforms and a self-built SaaS product — for businesses across Zimbabwe, SADC, and remote-first companies. Specialize in AI-powered products: RAG chatbots, multimodal vision, and semantic search.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Contractor

Fullstack & AI Engineer

April 2023 – Present | Harare, Zimbabwe · Remote

- Shipped 3 client platforms plus a self-built SaaS product (Mom & Pop POS), specializing in offline-first systems, secure payment flows, and AI-powered features.
- Built RAG pipelines that query live business data — replacing first-line customer support and turning product discovery into natural-language conversations.
- Architected full-stack products end to end: database design, REST APIs, React/Next.js frontends, CI/CD, and VPS deployment via Docker and Nginx.

CLIENT & PRODUCT WORK

Mom & Pop POS

Laravel · React · Offline-First Sync | 2026

- Offline-first point-of-sale platform for shops, bars, and restaurants across Zimbabwe and SADC — keeps processing sales when the network drops, then reconciles and syncs across every till at cash-up.

Aligned Surveyors ERP & CRM

Laravel · React · WebSockets · WebRTC | 2026

- Full-stack ERP/CRM with real-time collaborative chat, secure P2P video conferencing, and a database-aware AI analytics layer for project insights without full page reloads.

Summit Guesthouse Platform

Laravel · PayNow Integration | 2023 · Rebuilt 2026

- Replaced manual bookings with a 24/7 automated storefront and end-to-end PayNow payment integration — secure transaction initiation, async webhook confirmation, and idempotent order state.

Zamsam Engineering Platform

Next.js · Chatbase GPT · WhatsApp API | 2024 · Refurbished 2026

- Next.js marketing platform with a Chatbase GPT assistant qualifying inbound leads, plus an automated WhatsApp pipeline routing high-intent visitors to appointment booking.

PERSONAL & HOBBY PROJECTS

Pokédex AI — Multimodal Vision Pipeline

Gemini Vision · PokéAPI · Voice I/O | 2025

- Multimodal image-to-data pipeline: point a camera at any Pokémon and Gemini Vision identifies it, returning stats, types, and evolution data via voice output.
- Self-augmenting retrieval: checks local cache first, falls back to PokéAPI, and uses Gemini to generate and cache missing entries — improving with every use.
- Domain-agnostic architecture applicable to menu allergy detection, receipt scanning, and structured data extraction.

Handcrafted Haven — AI Marketplace

Next.js · Prisma · PostgreSQL · RAG | 2025 · Extended 2026

- Decoupled marketplace with a RAG assistant that answers live catalog questions and reasons up categories when exact matches don't exist (e.g., kitchen knives → cutting board).
- Originally a university project; extended into a reusable e-commerce foundation for client deployments.

SKILLS

Languages

PHP · JavaScript · TypeScript · Python · SQL

Frontend

React · Next.js · Inertia.js · Tailwind

Backend

Laravel · Node.js · Express · REST APIs · WebSockets · WebRTC

Databases

PostgreSQL · MySQL · Prisma · Redis

AI & Automation

RAG · LLM Integration · Prompt Engineering · Gemini · Grok · Chatbase · Multimodal Vision · Semantic Search

Payments & Cloud

PayNow · Webhooks · Docker · CI/CD · AWS · Vercel · Nginx · Linux · VPS

EDUCATION

BYU – Idaho

BSc in Software Dev
Conferred 2026

BYU – Idaho

Associate Degree, Soft Dev
2025

ALX Africa

Backend Dev Cert
2024 – 2025

ALX Africa

Software Engineering
2024

LANGUAGES

English (Native)
Shona (Native)